



Pokémon Go case?

Someone made a phone case which helps you aim your pokeball better
digit.in/pokeCase



iPhone7 release date

Evan Blass (@evleaks) leaks the iPhone 7 release date – September 12
digit.in/iPhone7rel

EMOTING OUT LOUD: THE ORIGIN OF EMOJIS

Emotions are no longer difficult to express, thanks to the myriad of expressive faces depicting your reaction to various situations. This month, we trace the sources of the world's first emoji, and it's story of evolving through an assembly of dots and colons to graphic mimicry.

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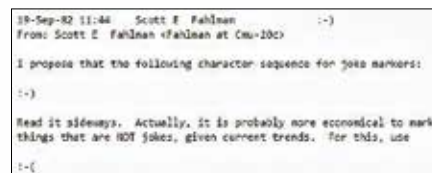
On July 17, we commemorated World Emoji Day. In true millennial fashion, the world took to social media and celebrated the presence of emojis in our lives with... well, emojis. This is not the first time that an Internet-born inanimate object has been commemorated, though. For instance, World Wi-Fi Day was celebrated on June 20 to honour the magical airwaves that connect us to the rest of the world in a matter of seconds, and World Internet Day is observed on October 29 in honour of, well, the Internet. Hence, it is only natural that we celebrate emojis too, the tiny, round faces in varying shades of emotion that are ever-present in our messages these days.

THE ORIGIN

As with much of technology, emojis also have their roots in Japan. Shigetaka Kurita was a part of Japanese telecom operator NTT DoCoMo's i-Mode mobile Internet platform that witnessed a rising trend of using pictures in text messages to depict reactions and/or emotions. This was some time between 1998 and 1999, and the brink of the millennium was witnessing the widespread acceptance of mobile telephony, the advent of commonplace text messaging, and Japan was one

step ahead already. To serve the users better, Kurita and his team came up with emoticons, a total of 172 faces depicting the various emotions and reactions that he had witnessed among the people in his city. Each emoticon had a size of 12x12 pixels, and was a part of a special package for NTT DoCoMo customers to differentiate the service provider from the rest and appeal more to users.

While Kurita and his team at i-Mode have usually been credited with the invention of the world's first emojis, this is the



The first recorded presence of emoji

time when a number of Japanese telecom providers came up with similar solutions and layouts. Vodafone Japan also happened to be one of the early adopters of emoji, and the link for emojis spreading out across the world can be drawn from here. Even prior to the presence of graphic emojis, people using text messages have resorted to ASCII symbols to emote. These were basically combinations of punctuation marks that somewhat created a barebone sketch of how you were feeling at that moment, forming a precursor to the myriad emoti-

cons we have around us now. The very first recorded use of emoticons were the two basic smiling and sad faces, :-) and :- (, by Scott Fahlman, a computer scientist at Carnegie Mellon University.

The mention of the concept though, dates further back to Vladimir Nabokov's interview with The New York Times back in 1969, when he stated, "I often think there should exist a special typographical sign for a smile — some sort of concave mark, a supine round bracket."

THE EVOLUTION

The first graphical representations of the symbol-based emoticons were brought to the fore by Nicolas Loufrani, son of The Smiley Company's President Franklin Loufrani, who decided to take up the mettle of innovating with the basic smiley, and create animated graphics to ease communications. He realised the potential of digital communication and in the years to follow, compiled an emoticon dictionary, a precursor to the extensive list of emojis we use these days. Loufrani's company presently holds copyright to the smiley face and its usage across multiple nations, prior to which his online emoticon dictionary included sub-genres of emojis such as Classics, Food, Sports, Weather, Animals, Nations and many more.

The development of emoji made it easier for telecom servers to handle the ever-growing scale of text messages, and